

Cat Counter Surfing Fix — Action Checklist

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AUDIT YOUR SPACE

- ☐ **Audit Your Space, Walk through your kitchen as if you were your cat to identify where they jump up from and what they see, because this reveals exactly what makes the space irresistible to them.:** Audit Your Space, Walk through your kitchen as if you were your cat to identify where they jump up from and what they see, because this reveals exactly what makes the space irresistible to them.
- ☐ **Audit Your Space, Score your counter attractiveness by answering whether food, crumbs, small objects, windows with wildlife, or comfortable jumping height exist, because a score of 3 or more means your counters are too appealing.:** Audit Your Space, Score your counter attractiveness by answering whether food, crumbs, small objects, windows with wildlife, or comfortable jumping height exist, because a score of 3 or more means your counters are too appealing.
- ☐ **Audit Your Space, Identify all jump-up points and triggers by walking slowly through your kitchen and noting where your cat launches themselves, because knowing these exact locations lets you place deterrents where they matter most.:** Audit Your Space, Identify all jump-up points and triggers by walking slowly through your kitchen and noting where your cat launches themselves, because knowing these exact locations lets you place deterrents where they matter most.
- ☐ **Audit Your Space, Remove food items, crumbs, and small objects from counters before implementing behavioral changes, because eliminating these primary motivations makes the counter immediately less interesting to your cat.:** Audit Your Space, Remove food items, crumbs, and small objects from counters before implementing behavioral changes, because eliminating these primary motivations makes the counter immediately less interesting to your cat.

DETER PROBLEM BEHAVIORS

- ☐ **Deter Problem Behaviors, Apply double-sided tape along counter edges and surfaces where your cat jumps up, because the sticky texture creates an unpleasant sensation that most cats avoid within 2-3 weeks of consistent use.:** Deter Problem Behaviors, Apply double-sided tape along counter edges and surfaces where your cat jumps up, because the sticky texture creates an unpleasant sensation that most cats avoid within 2-3 weeks of consistent use.

- ❑ **Deter Problem Behaviors, Place texture deterrents like aluminum foil or commercial sticky strips BEFORE your cat jumps onto the counter, because catching them after the fact and then applying deterrent doesn't create the necessary association.:** Deter Problem Behaviors, Place texture deterrents like aluminum foil or commercial sticky strips BEFORE your cat jumps onto the counter, because catching them after the fact and then applying deterrent doesn't create the necessary association.
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- ❑ **Deter Problem Behaviors, Spray a diluted citrus solution on counters and problem areas using lemon or orange essential oils, because cats dislike the smell and this creates a natural aversion without harmful chemicals.:** Deter Problem Behaviors, Spray a diluted citrus solution on counters and problem areas using lemon or orange essential oils, because cats dislike the smell and this creates a natural aversion without harmful chemicals.
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- ❑ **Deter Problem Behaviors, Avoid using spray bottles, air horns, nose tapping, or sudden loud noises as deterrents, because punitive methods damage trust and teach your cat to knock things off only when you're not looking.:** Deter Problem Behaviors, Avoid using spray bottles, air horns, nose tapping, or sudden loud noises as deterrents, because punitive methods damage trust and teach your cat to knock things off only when you're not looking.
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GIVE BETTER ALTERNATIVES

- ❑ **Give Better Alternatives, Install a window perch or cat shelf near a bird feeder or wildlife view, because your cat needs an elevated spot that feels even better than your counter and satisfies their hunting instincts.:** Give Better Alternatives, Install a window perch or cat shelf near a bird feeder or wildlife view, because your cat needs an elevated spot that feels even better than your counter and satisfies their hunting instincts.
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- ❑ **Give Better Alternatives, Provide dedicated vertical spaces like cat trees or wall shelves near the kitchen entrance, because giving your cat their own appealing territory reduces the desire to claim your surfaces instead.:** Give Better Alternatives, Provide dedicated vertical spaces like cat trees or wall shelves near the kitchen entrance, because giving your cat their own appealing territory reduces the desire to claim your surfaces instead.
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- ❑ **Give Better Alternatives, Establish a daily counter clearance routine by putting keys, coins, jewelry, and food items away every time you leave the kitchen, because an empty counter quickly becomes a boring counter.:** Give Better Alternatives, Establish a daily counter clearance routine by putting keys, coins, jewelry, and food items away every time you leave the kitchen, because an empty counter quickly becomes a boring counter.
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- ☐ **Give Better Alternatives, Position cat toys, scratchers, or interactive feeders near problem areas to redirect attention, because replacing negative behavior requires making positive alternatives immediately accessible.:** Give Better Alternatives, Position cat toys, scratchers, or interactive feeders near problem areas to redirect attention, because replacing negative behavior requires making positive alternatives immediately accessible.

Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.